Diamael "James" M. Lucman

Prof. Diamael "James" M. Lucman (rahimahullah) was a Filipino academic, public administrator, and civic leader whose name carries real weight across Mindanao's socio-political landscape.

He is best remembered for his lifelong bond with Mindanao State University (MSU), a relationship that took him from wide-eyed student to campus leader to, eventually, the university's Acting President in 1999.

Along the way, he also found time to serve his country in national government, keep the lights on for entire rural communities, and lead one of the country's most storied fraternities. It's the kind of resume that reads less like a single career and more like four.

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Early Life and Academic Foundation

Lucman grew up in Marawi City and Bayang, Lanao del Sur, right in the heart of Maranao culture and history.

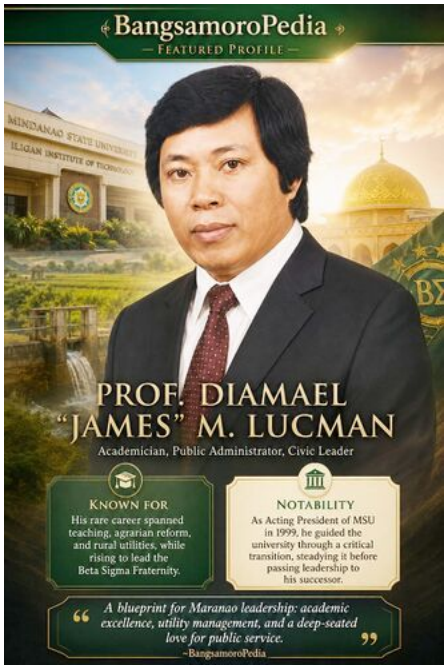
His connection to Mindanao State University started early: he attended MSU Preparatory High School, graduating in 1968.

He never really left. Lucman stayed on at MSU for his college years, earning his bachelor's degree in Community Development and Public Administration in 1975.

Even as a student, he was already a leader in the making. He was elected Student Council President, a post that came with a seat on the university's highest governing body, the MSU Board of Regents.

Hungry to sharpen his understanding of governance, Lucman eventually made his way to Manila, where he completed a Master in Public Administration at the University of the Philippines Manila in 1977.

Prof. Diamael "James" M. Lucman



Born

Marawi City and Bayang, Lanao del Sur, Philippines

Alma Mater

MSU Preparatory High School (1968); Mindanao State University, BS Community Development and Public Administration (1975); University of the Philippines Manila, Master in Public Administration (1977)

Occupation

Academician, Public Administrator, Civic Leader

Notable Position

Acting President, Mindanao State University System (1999)

Government Service

Undersecretary, Department of Agrarian Reform; **Manager**, Lanao del Sur Electric Cooperative (LASURECO)

Fraternity

Pioneer Member, MSU Beta Sigma Fraternity; National **President**, Beta Sigma Philippines

Spouse

Bae Tondogun Disomimba

Children

Haroun "Toxi" Lucman III, among others

Notability

Institutional and Academic Contributions

Degree in hand, Lucman went home to Marawi City to teach, choosing to pour his knowledge back into the next generation of Mindanao's leaders.

He rose through the academic ranks at MSU, eventually earning the title of Professor VI, with a specialization in public administration and regional development.

The high point of his institutional career came in 1999, when he was designated Acting President of the entire Mindanao State University System.

He stepped into the role right after the historic term of Hadja Sittie Nurlaylah Emily M. Marohombsar, MSU's first female president, and carried the university through a delicate stretch: keeping academic operations stable, looking after student welfare, and holding the line on day-to-day campus management before passing the baton to his successor.

Guided Mindanao State University through a critical transition period as its Acting President in 1999, stepping in right after the university's first female president and steadying the institution before handing it over to his successor.

Known For

A rare career that moved seamlessly between the classroom, the halls of national agrarian reform, and the wiring and utility lines of rural Lanao del Sur, all while rising to the top leadership post of the Beta Sigma Fraternity.

Pull Quote

"A blueprint for Maranao leadership: academic excellence, utility management, and a deep-seated love for public service."

Public Service and Utility Management

Lucman's talents were never confined to the university gates.

He was called into national service as Undersecretary for the Department of Agrarian Reform, where he helped steer land reform initiatives and rural development, bringing a genuinely southern, Mindanaoan perspective to national agrarian policy.

Closer to home, he took on the very grounded, very practical job of Manager of the Lanao del Sur Electric Cooperative (LASURECO). Running a utility cooperative isn't glamorous work, but it mattered enormously: it meant grappling with the everyday energy challenges of the province and working to bring dependable power to rural Maranao communities.

Civic Leadership and Fraternity Status

Within Philippine student culture and civic circles, Lucman holds something close to legendary status.

He was among the very first pioneer members of the MSU chapter of the Beta Sigma Fraternity, and his commitment to its ideals of brotherhood and community service eventually carried him all the way to the top of the organization, as President of Beta Sigma Philippines.

Personal Life and Family Legacy

Lucman came from a prominent regional lineage and built a family just as devoted to public welfare as he was.

He was married to Bae Tondogun Disomimba, a respected civic figure in her own right who served as a manager for human settlements and was the sister of former mayor Topaan Disomimba.

Prof. James Lucman passed away leaving behind a blueprint for Maranao leadership that blended academic excellence, utility management, and a deep, unwavering commitment to public service.

See Also

- Mindanao State University
- Haroun Lucman III
- Beta Sigma Fraternity
- Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao

References

- Family and community records, compiled and shared by the Lucman family
- Mindanao State University institutional records
- Cross-checked and verified biographical report, Google AI

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